



Islam 101 Guide for Reverts





At DailySunnah, we believe that true peace comes from aligning our lives with the wisdom of the Prophet ﷺ and the guidance of the Quran. In a world filled with distractions and stress, the Sunnah offers a blueprint for inner calm, resilience, and barakah-filled living.

Our goal? To help you cultivate a life of presence, purpose, and connection—with Allah, with yourself, and with the Prophetic way. Every product we create is designed to be practical, rooted in Islamic values, and supportive of your well-being—so that caring for your mental, emotional, and spiritual health feels natural and effortless.

Ready to integrate the Sunnah into your daily life? Explore our collection, find what resonates, and take that next step toward a life filled with barakah. Because when we live by the Sunnah, we don't just survive—we thrive.

CONTENTS

Let's start with the basics.....	2
Who is Allah (SWT)?.....	3
Who is the Prophet Muhammad? (PBUH).....	4
What is the Quran?.....	5
What are the 5 Pillars of Islam?.....	7
Glossary of terms you will see often.....	14
Halal vs haram.....	15
How to find halal food.....	16
Wudu.....	17
How many prayers do I need to read?.....	18
Step-by-step prayer guide.....	19
Islam and Women.....	23
Sources and more reading.....	24

Let's start with the basics!

Before diving into the beauties and complexities of Islam, it is beneficial to learn the most fundamental terms. Inshallah, this will ease your understanding.

"**Islam**" is an Arabic term signifying the act of surrendering one's will to the divine will of God. It is a monotheistic faith emphasizing the belief in a single, supreme Creator. A "**Muslim**" is one who follows Islam, regarding it as the authentic religion revealed by God to humanity. Islam is open to people of all backgrounds and is characterized by the core principle of complete submission to the will of God.

Can anyone be a Muslim? Islam is a welcoming faith. Anyone who accepts that there is only one God and the Prophet Muhammad is His messenger (we'll get more into this later!) can be a Muslim. That's it!

Do I need to speak Arabic to be a Muslim?

The Holy Quran is written in Arabic, and we read our daily prayers in Arabic. It is preferable to read the Quran in its original Arabic form. However, it is permitted to read translations of the Quran. There are many versions, however for an English translation I recommend "The Clear Quran" for its simple and direct language.



Who is Allah (SWT)?

Allah is God. There are 99 names of Allah, the most common that you will see is **Allah subhanahu wa ta'ala (SWT)**. This means "May He be praised and exalted".

You will see this calligraphy often; this means Allah (SWT).



What do I need to know about Allah (SWT) to start my journey ?

01

There is only one God. Allah (SWT) is the universal name for God. It does not mean an 'Islamic' God, as we believe there is only one God period.

03

Is Allah (SWT) merciful? Allah (SWT) is the Most Merciful. "And whoever does a wrong or wrongs himself but then seeks forgiveness of Allah will find Allah Forgiving and Merciful" (Quran 4:110). If you truly repent in your heart, Allah (SWT) will forgive you.

02

Why did he create mankind?

Muslims believe that Allah (SWT) created humankind for a simple purpose – to worship Him and Him only

04

Does Allah (SWT) know everything?

Allah (SWT) knows all that is within our hearts. Allah (SWT)'s knowledge and wisdom compasses all things. There is nothing on Earth that escapes His notice. He sees everything we do and hears every thought. Because of this, it is important to perform good deeds and avoid harm.

Who is the Prophet Muhammad? (PBUH)

Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) is the last Messenger. PBUH means "Peace be upon Him", and is usually added after a Prophet's name out of respect. Muslims believe that Allah (SWT) revealed the Quran to the Prophet Muhammad. He then spread the teachings of Islam.

You will see this calligraphy often; this means Prophet Muhammad (PBUH).



What do I need to know about Prophet (PBUH) to start my journey ?

01

Is the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) the Son of God?

No. Allah (SWT) has no other form. The Prophet Muhammad was a man like us, but the best version we can be. As Muslims, we strive to live like the Prophet, Inshallah.

02

Do Muslims pray to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH)

No. Our prayers are only directed to Allah (SWT). There are no others except Allah, so we cannot pray to anyone else. Praying to anyone except Allah (SWT) is not allowed.

03

The Prophet Muhammad advocated for womens' rights

The Prophet consulted women and considered their opinions seriously. Women were allowed to pray in mosques, and seek knowledge. He did not promote the oppression or harm of women.

04

Where is Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) buried?

His grave is in the city of Medina, in modern day Saudi Arabia. The Prophet's body is in Islam's second holiest site known as the Prophet's mosque.

What is the Quran?



01

The Quran is a book

It is a text contain truth and guidance for every human being. Muslims believe that these words were revealed directly by God, in Arabic, to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH).

02

Do I have to read the Quran to practice Islam?

Yes, as the central text is is crucial that Muslims read the Quran. You do not need to memorize the entire work (although if you do, you will be rewarded for it). You need to learn a few verses in order to complete your daily prayers. But don't worry: as we know, Allah (SWT) is merciful. Reciting the Surah Al-Ikhlās three times is considered equivalent to reading the entire Quran. It is only 4 verses, and a good option for beginners learning the Quran.

03

Are there any rules for reading the Quran?

Yes, a few. You should not put the Quran on the ground or in the garbage. If you no longer want a copy of the Quran, you can bring it to any mosque or you can burn it. Additionally, you should wash your hands before touching a physical copy. If you are a woman and have a period, you cannot touch a physical Quran until your period is over. However, you can still read a digital copy during this time.

04

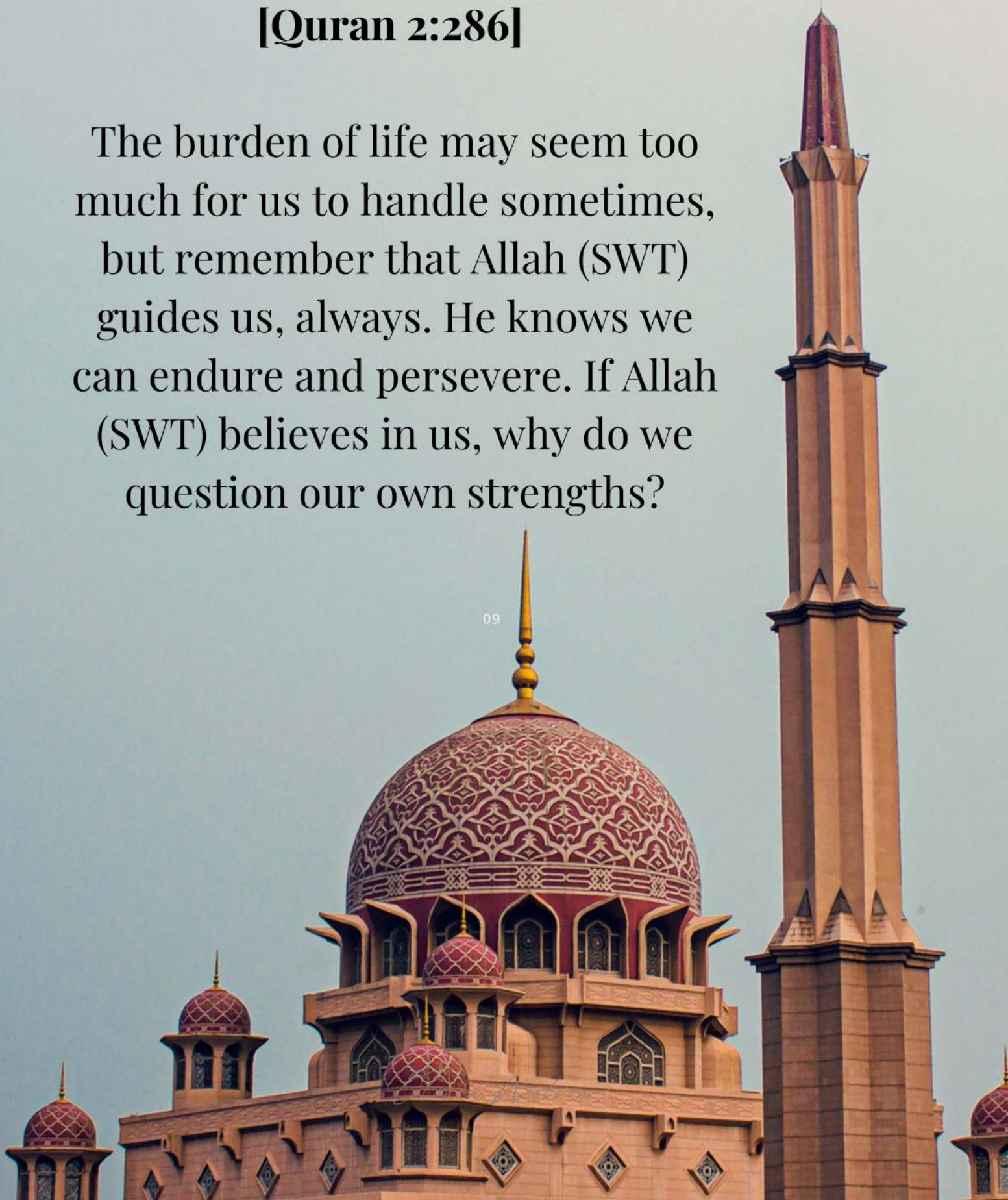
I'm overwhelmed! What chapter should I start with?

The Quran can seem overwhelming at the start. However, once you begin reading you will not be able to stop. It just makes sense. Begin with the first and most recited surah of the Quran, Surah Al Fatiha. This surah is significant because it provides the foundation for Muslim prayer and is often the first portion of the Quran that is memorized by children and reverts.

**“God does not burden any soul
with more than it can bear.”**

[Quran 2:286]

The burden of life may seem too much for us to handle sometimes, but remember that Allah (SWT) guides us, always. He knows we can endure and persevere. If Allah (SWT) believes in us, why do we question our own strengths?



What are the 5 Pillars of Islam?⁰⁷

As a revert, you need to know the 5 Pillars of Islam. These are the five core, fundamental practices all Muslims are obligated to fulfil throughout their lifetime.



The declaration of faith in one God (Allah (SWT)) and His messenger (peace be upon him). In Arabic, we say “la ilaha illallah muhammadur rasulullah”.



Muslims are required to pray 5 times a day, everyday.



Muslims must give a portion of their wealth to those in need throughout their lifetime. This is calculated based on your assets, and is different for everyone.



The act of fasting during the holy month of Ramadan. All healthy, able bodied Muslims must fast from sunrise to sundown.



If it is in their means, all Muslims must make the sacred pilgrimage to Mecca at least once in their lifetime.

Pillar 1: Shahada

" Shahada is the declaration of faith in Allah (SWT).



What does it mean?



la ilaha illallah muhammadur rasulullah means "I bear witness that there is no deity but Allah (SWT), and I bear witness that Muhammad is the messenger of Allah (SWT).

You can take your Shahada anywhere, at anytime. Reverts typically do so at a masjid or in front of witnesses, however this is not a requirement. As your faith is between you and God, you can do this at any time.

Once you say your Shahada, you are officially a Muslim! If you do it as a masjid, the imam can provide you with a document attesting to it. It is not necessary to have this to be a Muslim, but it can make it easier if you perform Hajj, Inshallah, since reverts with non-Muslim names need to prove that they reverted to enter Mecca.

Pillar 2: Salah

”

Salah (also known as namaz) is the prayer we perform 5 times a day



What does it mean?



Muslims pray to connect with Allah (SWT). It is an opportunity to slow down and re-establish our relationship with Allah (SWT).

Muslims pray 5 times a day, at set times. You can find your local prayer times online or at a masjid close to you. The 5 prayers are Fajr (early morning, before dawn), Dhuhr (mid-day, just after noon), Asr (mid afternoon), Maghrib (just after sunset) and Isha (at night, after dark has fallen).

It takes time to build the habit. It may take time to build the prayers into your day. Start slowly, setting a goal for one or two prayers a day. When that is sustainable, work your way to performing all 5 prayers, Inshallah. It is better to ease into it then to become frustrated or disconnected.

Pillar 3: Zakat

"

Zakat is a specified portion of a Muslim's wealth that is given to those in need.



What does it mean?



Zakat is a way for Muslims to purify their wealth and income. It enables us to purify our assets and earn the pleasure of Allah (SWT) because our wealth is distributed to those in need.

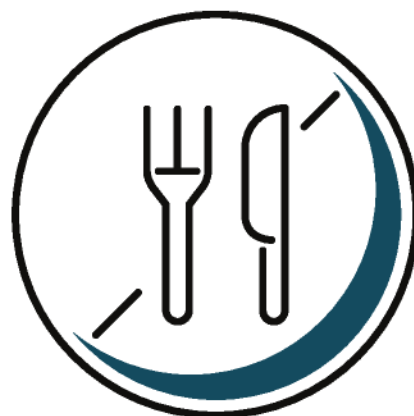
You have to calculate your nisaab. The nisaab is a minimum amount of wealth a person must have before zakat becomes due upon them. The wealth should be in their possession for one year.

Zakat is not required for those who do not meet the criteria. If you are a young person with a lot of debt, a parent living paycheque to paycheque, or a person whose wealth has not reached the nisaab (minimum amount) then zakat is not required for you.

Pillar 4: Fasting



Fasting is the practice of abstaining from eating food, drinking liquids, and having intercourse from the break of dawn until sunset.



What does it mean?

Fasting is obligatory upon every healthy adult Muslim, men and women. It is a time to strengthen our faith, gratitude and connection with Allah (SWT). You must fast if you are able.

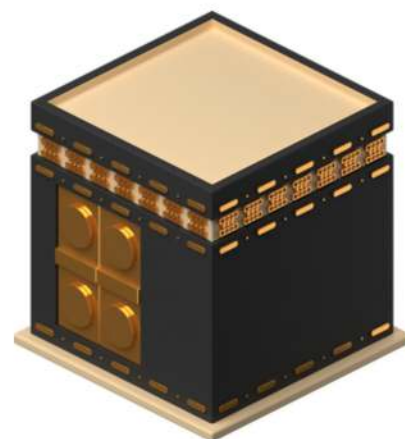
Ramadan lasts about 30 days. The dates change every year, based on the Islamic lunar calendar. It varies depending on what country you are in, and even across cities.

Fasting is not required in certain conditions. If you are pregnant or breastfeeding, you do not need to fast. If you are a woman and get your period, you do not need to fast during that time. If you have a health condition that endangers you, you do not need to fast.

Pillar 5: Hajj

”

Hajj is the pilgrimage that millions of Muslims make to Kaba, the Sacred House of Allah (SWT) in Makkah in modern day Saudi Arabia



What does it mean?



Hajj is obligatory upon every Muslim who is able.

Since it requires quite a bit of time, money and effort, it is only required to be done one time. It is one of the most important forms of worship in Islam.

Hajj takes place during the month of Dhul Hijjah.

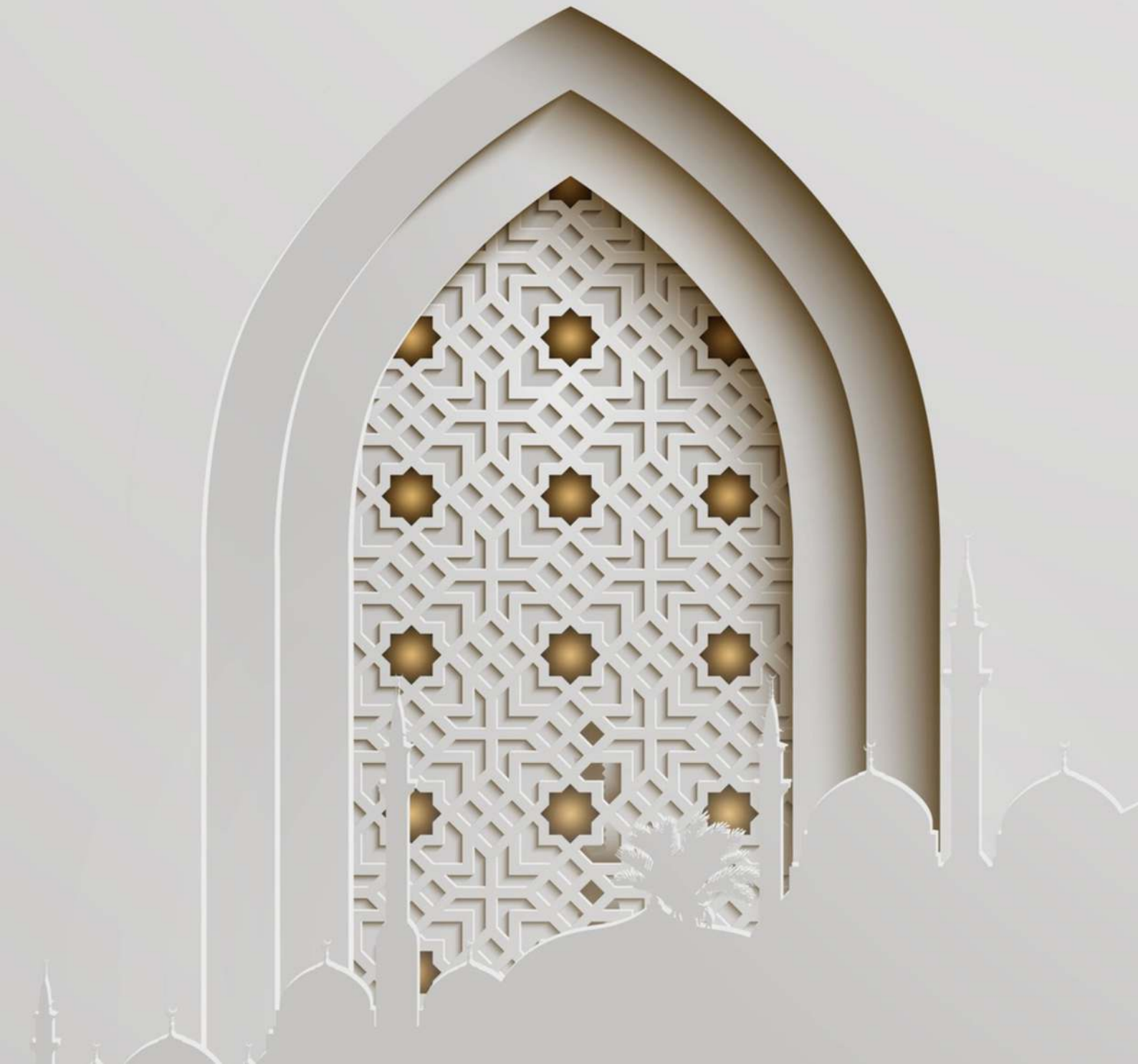
The dates change every year, based on the Islamic lunar calendar. It is the last month of the Islamic calendar.

Hajj grants you forgiveness from all sins

If you sincerely repent and complete Hajj, your sins will all be forgiven. This is a time to reflect on past deeds and seek guidance from Allah (SWT) on how to become a better Muslim going forward.

“Indeed, I am near.” [Quran 2:186]

This is a simple but beautiful verse for lonely reverts out there. It can be difficult to cope with the loneliness as a revert, when you do not have family or support close to you. You may feel isolated but you are never truly alone when you have Allah (SWT) in your life.



Glossary of terms you will see often

There are a lot of new words and concepts that a revert is exposed to. It can be hard to keep track of everything! Here are some key terms to know

Adhan (or Azan)

The Islamic call to prayer. It is said in Arabic and lets Muslims know that it is prayer time.

Assalam alaykum

Islamic greeting meaning may peace be upon you, usually said when arriving.

Bismillah

Meaning "in the name of Allah (SWT)", we say this before starting anything (eating, drinking, driving, etc).

Dua

An invocation. We can say duas to Allah (SWT) to ask about anything in life.

Eid ul-Fitr

Marks the end of Ramadan, celebrating the new moon sighting.

Eid ul-Adha

On the 10th day of Dhul Hijjah, Muslims celebrate by sacrificing an animal and distributing the meat to those in need.

Eid Mubarak

Celebratory greeting, meaning "May you have a blessed Eid."

Fard

Meaning "obligatory", such as minimum ra'kats Muslims must read as part of each prayer.

Halal

Meaning "permissible". Applies to Muslim practices, actions, and statements that are allowed.

Haram

Meaning "not permissible". Applies to Muslim practices, actions, and statements that are not allowed.

Jannah

Meaning "heaven" or "paradise". Muslims perform good deeds and charity to be admitted into Jannah.

Ka'bah

Cube structure in the centre of Masjid al Haram in Makkah. When Muslims pray, we must face the direction of the Ka'bah for our prayers to be accepted.

Laylat-ul-Qadr

Laylat-ul-Qadr is the holiest night of the year. Occurs during in the last ten nights of Ramadan.

Sunnah

An act of that is not obligatory, however is recommended, such as breaking your fast with a date.

Ummah

The global community of Muslims.

Walaykum assalam

This is the response when someone sends salam upon you.

Halal vs Haram

There are some lifestyle changes that all reverts must make. People will tell you it is difficult, but Allah (SWT) guides us at all times. Depending on your previous lifestyle, some changes may take more time to adjust to than others. However, none will burden you and there is always a halal option, even in Western countries.

HALAL

Halal slaughtered chicken,
beef, and lamb Seafood

HARAM

Pork Alcohol
Gelatin
Shortening/lard

These are the basics; there are many more that have more nuance (ex. vanilla extract for baking) and I recommend looking into the **hadiths** (scholarly opinions) for more insight.

But what if I didn't realize I was eating something haram: if you accidentally eat a bacon bit in a salad, you should stop eating it immediately. However, since it was not intentional, this is not considered a sin. Allah (SWT) is merciful, and does not fault us for accidentally eating haram. The same principle applies if someone gives you haram food without you knowing. This can happen to reverts especially, who may live in non Muslim homes and eat meals prepared by non- Muslim relatives. Don't panic-Allah is understanding.

How do I find Halal food?

Depending on where you live, it can be challenging to find halal food. Cities generally have a higher Muslim population than rural areas, so its easier to find both prepared and unprepared food.

01

Many major grocery stores, such as Walmart and Costco, carry a selection of halal meat. It does vary, but you can call or visit to check. A local Muslim butcher is also a great option, if possible.

02

For fast food: not a lot halal places, so opt for seafood or vegetarian/vegan options.

03

Food delivery apps such as UberEats and DoorDash have Halal filters, which really helps narrow down the search.



Look for this logo on packaging and in restaurants!

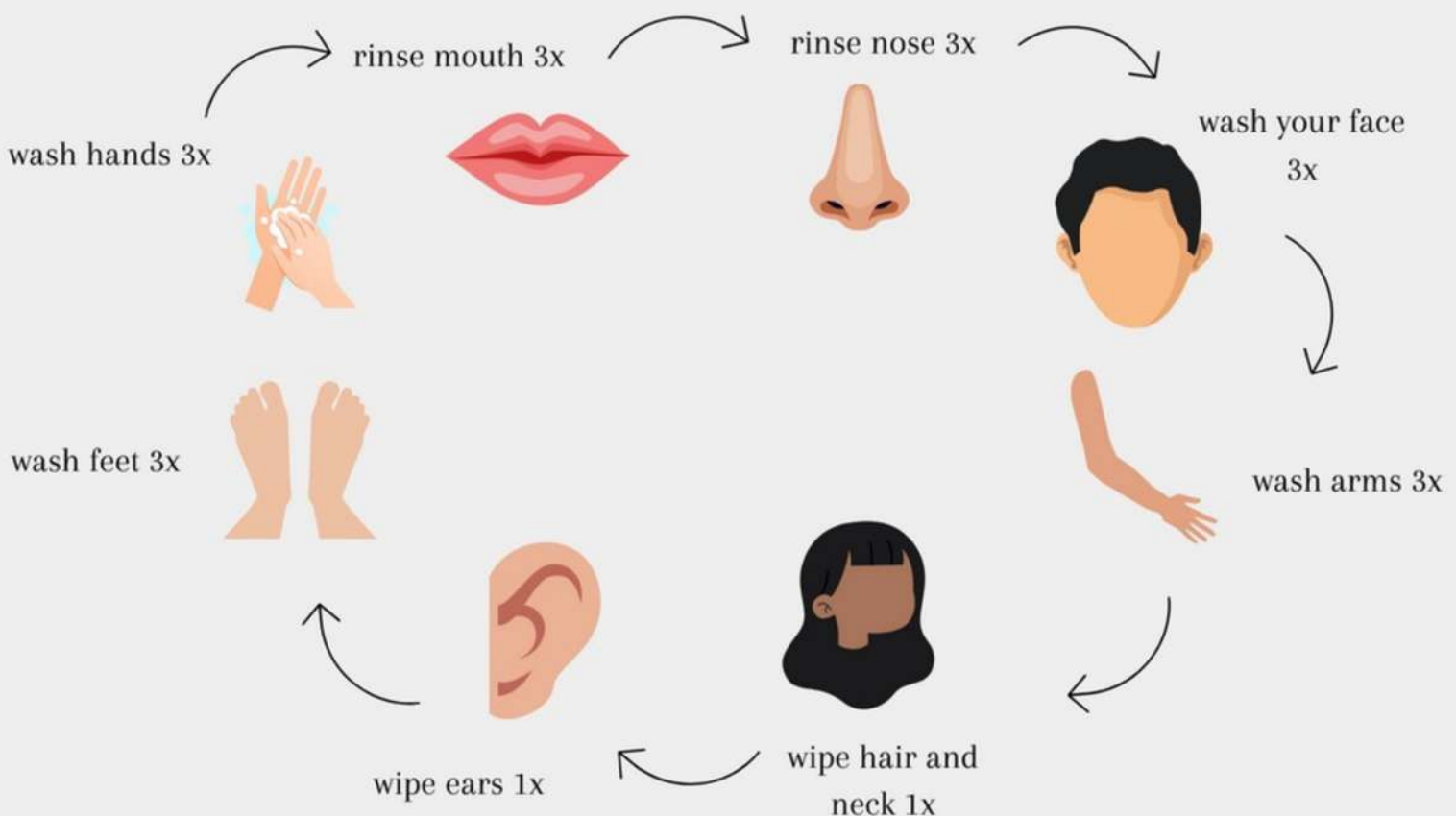
Wudu

17

Wudu is the act of purifying our bodies and minds before praying. It is important to present ourselves to Allah (SWT) in our best condition, so we clean ourselves before we begin salah. What breaks your wudu: going to the washroom, passing gas, sexual intimacy, vomiting, and heavy bleeding

wudu guide

intention Begin by saying: Bismillah



How many prayers do I need to read?

Each of the 5 prayers has a different number of ra'kats:

Sunnat: not mandatory, but preferable **Fard**: obligatory

Nafil: optional, gives you extra rewards **Vitar (Witr)**: not mandatory, but preferred



NAMAAZ RAK'ATS



Namaaz	Sunnat	Fard	Sunnat	Nafil	Vitar	Nafil
Fajr	2	2				
Dhuhr	4	4	2	2		
Asr	4	4				
Magrib		3	2	2		
Isha	4	4	2	2	3	2

How to Read Namaz

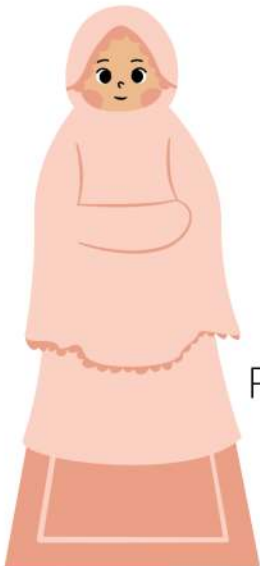


1

Raise your hands to your ears and say: "**Allahu Akbar.**" This means: "Allah is the Greatest". This is called Takbiratul Ihram. Then, cross your hands at chest level. Keep your eyes focused on the ground. Do not look around or get distracted.

2

Recite Surah Al-Fatiha (this Surah is recited in each Rak'ah):



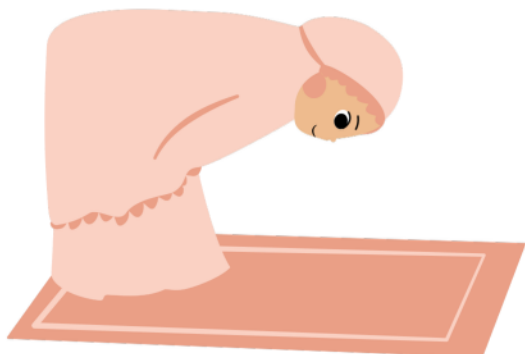
**Bismillaahir Rahmanir Raheem
Alhamdu lillaahi Rabbil 'aalameen
Ar-Rahmaanir-Raheem
Maaliki Yawmid-Deen
Iyyaaka na'budu wa iyyaaka nasta'een
Ihdinas-Siraatal-Mustaqeem
Siraatal-ladheena an'amta 'alaihim
Ghayril-maghdoobi 'alaihim wa lad-daaalleen**

Recite any other surah or any part of the Qu'ran, such as Surah Ikhlas:

**Qul huwal laahu ahad
Allah hus-samad
Lam yalid wa lam yoolad
Wa lam yakul-lahu kufuwan ahad**

3

Say "**Allahu Akbar**" and bend down. Keep your back and neck straight and level with the ground, keeping your eyes down and place your fingers and palm on your knees.

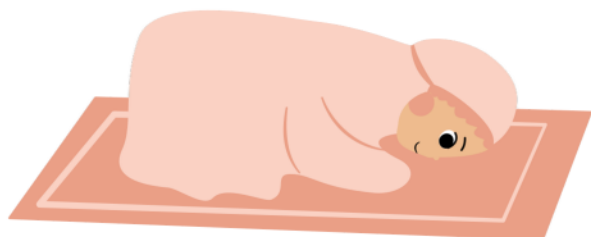


While bowing, say, **Subhanna Rabbiyal Adheem** three times. This means "Glorious is my Lord the most great."

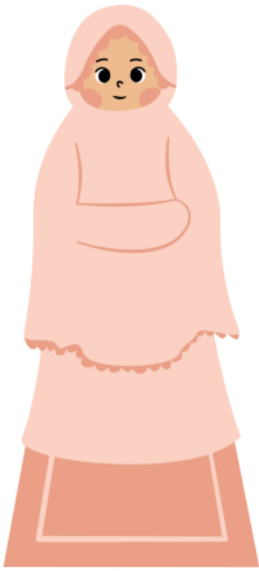
Stand back up. While rising up say **Samiallah Huliman Hamidah** with your arms loosely beside you. This means "Allah hears those who praise Him". While standing up, recite **Rabana Walakal Hamd** (Our Lord, all praise is for you) once.

4

Say **Allahu Akbar** and prostrate. Place your head, knees and hands on the floor. Your forehead should touch the ground. Then say **Subhanna Rabbiyal A'laa** (Glorious is my Lord, the most High) three times. Your forearms should not be on the floor.

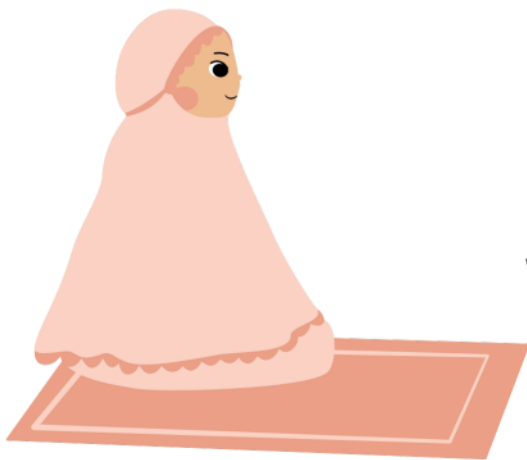


5



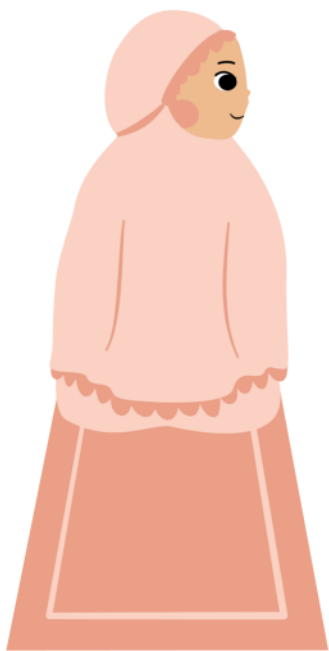
Say **Allahu Akbar** and stand up.
You have completed one rak'at!
Depending on the salah, you may
do this 1, 2, or 3 more times.

6 Repeat steps 1-5. Then in every even
numbered rak'aat, stay seated on your knees
instead of standing up. Say:



Tashahhud: **At-tahiyyaatu Lillaahi was-
salaawaatu wat-tayyibaat. As-salaamu
'alayka ayyuhan-Nabiyyu wa
rahmatullaahi wa barakaatuhu. As-
salaamu 'alayna wa 'ala 'ibaad-illaah-his-
saaliheen. Ash-hadu al-aa ilaaha ill-Allaah
wa ash-hadu anna Muhammadan 'abduhu
wa rasooluhu**

Durood: **Allaahumma salli 'ala
Muhammad, wa 'ala aali Muhammad,
kama sallayta 'ala Ibraaheem, wa 'ala aali
Ibraaheem, fil aalameen innak
hameedun majeed, wa baarik 'ala
Muhammad, wa 'ala aali Muhammad,
kama baarakta 'ala Ibraaheem, wa 'ala
aali Ibraaheem, fil aalameen innak
hameedun majeed**



Finish the prayer with any dua, and then tasleem. Turn your head to the right and say **As-salamu alaykum wa Rahmatullahi wa Barakaatuhu**. The angel who records your good deeds is to this side.

Turning your head to the left and say **As-salamu alaykum wa Rahmatullahi wa Barakaatuhu**. The angel who records your wrongful deeds is to this side. This completes 2 rak'ats!

Can I read namaz at any time? You can read each daily prayer during the period that is covered. This means that you can pray Asr at any time before Maghrib. It is preferable to read it as soon after the azan as possible, but if you can't get to it until later that's fine!

What about when I am menstruating? Allah (SWT) does not burden us beyond reason. When a women is menstruating, she is not permitted to pray. This is partly because bleeding invalidates wudu, and so you cannot complete this part. It is also because Allah is merciful, and knows that we are already in discomfort or pain. He allows us this break. When our period is over, we perform ghsul (a full body purification), and then we can resume prayer. You do not need to make up for missed prayer.

Islam and Women

There are many misconceptions about how Islam regards women. In reality, men and women are both created in the image of Allah (SWT). We are equals.



01

In Islam, men and women are equals

Islam refutes the idea that Eve tempted Adam to disobey God, The Quran says that they both disobeyed, and negates the idea that women are a source of evil. This places men and women on equal footing, both able to perform good and bad deeds freely.

02

Women have the same rights as men

Islam elevates the position of women in society and treats them as equals to men. Women have as much right to education and seeking knowledge. Women have the right to accept or reject marriage proposals. They have full freedom of expression, freedom to earn an income, and freedom to inherit. It is society that places these restrictions on women, not Islam. Islam is perfect, Muslims are not.

03

Islam has high regard for motherhood

Allah (SWT) gives mothers a high status and elevates their position in the family. In the Quran, Allah notes all the sacrifices mothers make when bearing children to remind people to treat their mothers with love, respect, and care. Emphasizing the importance of mothers, the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said, "Heaven lies under the feet of your mother."

04

Islam and Hijab: it is preferred, but not compulsory

The requirement to wear Hijab is a controversial debate. Some maintain that the Quran mandates full modesty, which entails women being fully covered head to toe. Others have a looser interpretation, that modesty does not require a hijab. In either case, women cannot be forced to wear a hijab. It must be a choice she makes on her own. Inshallah, as a revert you will have your own journey towards hijab and be a representative of Islam to the world.

SOURCES AND MORE READING

24

One of the aspects of Islam I love the most is that you are encouraged to research and think critically about it. It is a perfect religion, so it is not afraid of your questions. Always seek more knowledge on topics that you are unsure about or want to learn more about. Your local masjid is a good place to start, as are resources such as these.

[MyMasjid: Beginners Guide to Islam](#)

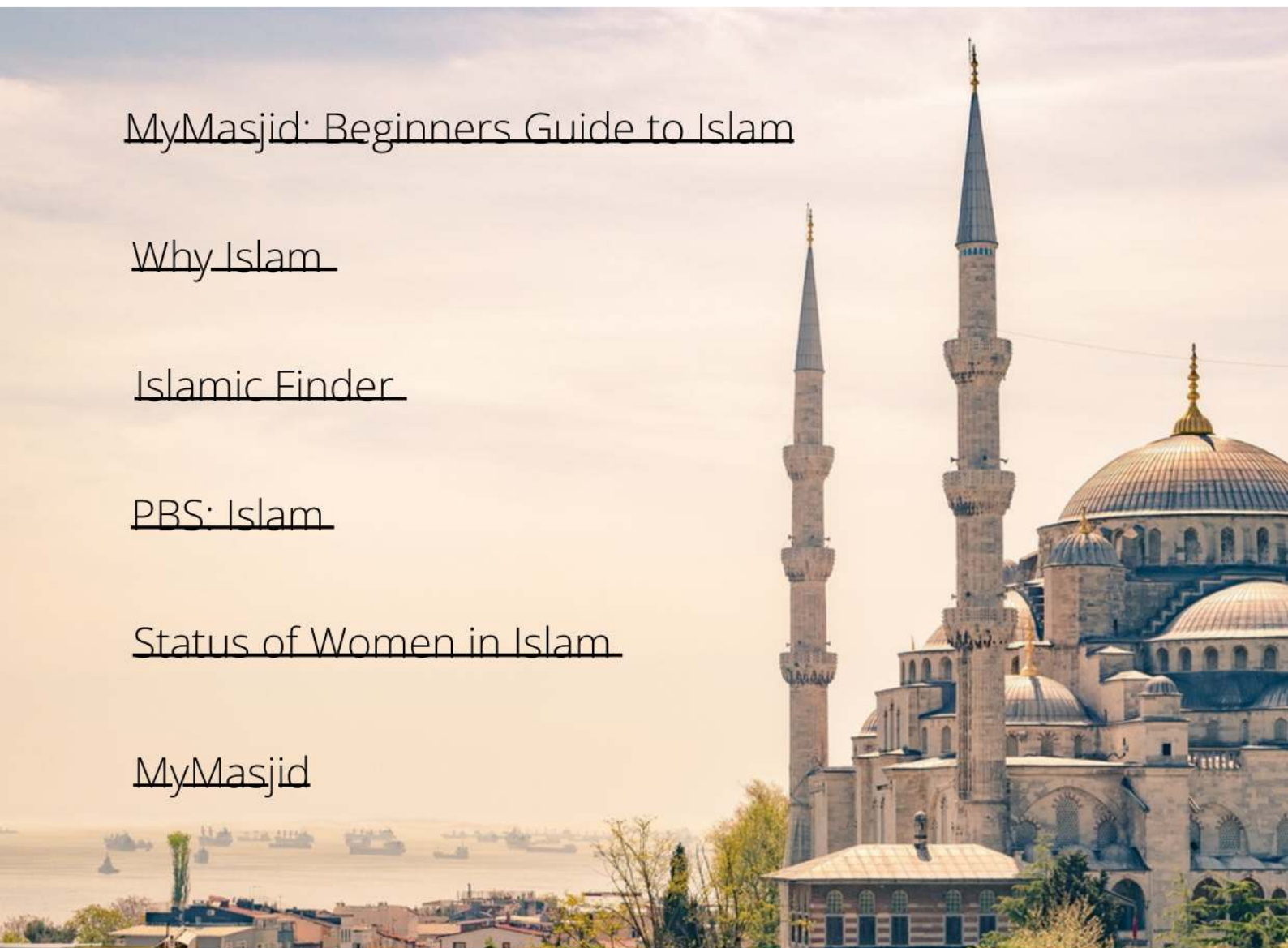
[Why Islam](#)

[Islamic Finder](#)

[PBS: Islam](#)

[Status of Women in Islam](#)

[MyMasjid](#)



**For God is with those who are mindful of
Him and who do good.” [Quran 16:128]**

**Allah (SWT) tells us He will always be with
those who do good, no matter what happens.
Remember, you are never alone. Keep doing
good to others, and InshaAllah, He is always
with you.**

